SAME SEX, SAME RIGHTS

As homosexual couples seek legal sanction for their unions, they encounter socio-political opposition. The ball is now in the country's apex court to find a balanced solution

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Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**

CASE STUDY

'THERE ARE THINGS WE CAN'T DO TOGETHER'

ADITI ANAND, *40*
Filmmaker and entrepreneur (top)

SUSAN DIAS, *35*
Entrepreneur and Director, Native Brews

Aditi and Susan live in Gurugram

Aditi and Susan have built a life for themselves that's enriched by love, companionship, equality, an affectionate dog and an adopted two-and-a-half-year-old son. Yet, there are so many things that they can't do together, including being legal parents to their son. Like many other couples, one of them adopted their son as a single parent. But now it violates the adoption norm issued last year by India's Central Adoption Resource Authority (CARA), which states that two unmarried individuals irrespective of their sexual orientation cannot adopt a child as a single parent. That's one of the reasons why the couple decided to fight for their rights and file a petition. "We don't want our son to be embarrassed when he grows up," they say. "We want to raise our child with respect and dignity."